

Sparrow Garage Doors Website

Setup & Deployment Guide — everything needed to run and publish the site

This document walks you through getting the website live from scratch. No prior knowledge of the project is assumed. You will create a few free accounts, plug in some settings, and click Deploy. The whole process takes roughly 30–45 minutes.

What this website is

A marketing website for a Brisbane garage door business. It has a home page, service pages, a blog, a photo gallery, contact and quote forms, and location pages.

It also has a **built-in admin area** (a login page at `/admin`) where the business owner can edit almost all of the website's text, change the phone number and email everywhere at once, and upload or swap out images — without touching any code.

What you'll need (all free to start)

Account	What it's for	Where
GitHub	Stores the website's code	github.com
Vercel	Hosts the live website	vercel.com
Resend	Delivers the contact/quote form emails	resend.com

You'll also need **Node.js** installed if you want to run the site on your own computer first (optional). Download the "LTS" version from **nodejs.org**.

Step 1 — Put the code on GitHub

1. Create a free GitHub account and a new **empty repository** (e.g. named `sparrow-garage-doors`). Keep it Private.
2. Upload this project's files into that repository. The easiest way: on the new repo's page, use **"uploading an existing file"** and drag in the project folder's contents. (Skip the `node_modules` folder if present — it's large and not needed.)

Step 2 — Set up form emails (Resend)

1. Create a free account at resend.com.
2. Verify the sending domain, or use their test sender to begin with.
3. Go to **API Keys** and create one. Copy it somewhere safe — you'll paste it in Step 4. It looks like `re_XXXXXXX`.

Step 3 — Connect the site to Vercel

1. Create a free account at vercel.com and sign in with GitHub.

2. Click **Add New** → **Project**, choose the GitHub repository from Step 1, and click **Import**.
3. Vercel auto-detects it as a Next.js project. **Don't deploy yet** — first add the settings in Step 4.

Step 4 — Enter the settings (environment variables)

In Vercel, on the import screen (or later under **Project** → **Settings** → **Environment Variables**), add each of these. Left column is the exact name; right column is what to put.

Name	Value to enter
<code>RESEND_API_KEY</code>	The key you copied from Resend in Step 2
<code>CONTACT_TO_EMAIL</code>	The email address that should receive form enquiries
<code>NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL</code>	The final website address, e.g. <code>https://www.sparrowgaragedoors.com</code> (no slash at the end)
<code>ADMIN_USERNAME</code>	A username for the owner's admin login, e.g. <code>admin</code>
<code>ADMIN_PASSWORD</code>	A strong password for the admin login (choose your own)
<code>ADMIN_SESSION_SECRET</code>	Any long random string of letters/numbers (30+ characters)

There is one more setting, `BLOB_READ_WRITE_TOKEN`, that you do **not** type in manually — it gets added automatically in Step 5.

Step 5 — Turn on storage for the admin area

The admin area saves edited text and uploaded images into Vercel's storage service. This must be switched on or the owner's changes won't be saved.

1. In your Vercel project, open the **Storage** tab.
2. Click **Create Database**, choose **Blob**, and connect it to this project.
3. That's it — Vercel automatically adds the `BLOB_READ_WRITE_TOKEN` setting for you.

Step 6 — Deploy

1. Go to the **Deployments** tab and click **Redeploy** (or **Deploy** if you haven't yet).
2. Wait a couple of minutes. Vercel gives you a live web address ending in `.vercel.app`.
3. Open it — the website is live.

Step 7 — Point the real domain at it (when ready)

1. In Vercel: **Project** → **Settings** → **Domains**, add the business's domain name.
2. Follow Vercel's on-screen instructions to update the domain's DNS records.
3. Make sure `NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL` (Step 4) matches this final domain, then redeploy once.

Using the admin area

Once live, the business owner (or you) can edit the site's content:

- Go to **your-website-address/admin**
- Log in with the `ADMIN_USERNAME` and `ADMIN_PASSWORD` from Step 4
- Edit any text or image, then press **Save**. Changes appear on the live site immediately.

Editable items include the business name, phone number and email (these update everywhere on the site at once), the home page, services, reviews, FAQs, footer, and contact page — plus every image, which can be uploaded or picked from what's already there.

Running it on your own computer (optional)

Only needed if you want to preview or change the code before deploying. With Node.js installed, open a terminal in the project folder:

```
npm install
npm run dev
```

Then open `http://localhost:3000`. Create a file named `.env.local` in the project folder and copy the same settings from Step 4 into it (one per line, e.g. `ADMIN_PASSWORD=yourpassword`). A ready-made template exists in the file `.env.example`.

Adding Google Ads / Analytics tracking

No tracking or advertising tags are installed yet — this is left for you to add. The two things you'll typically want:

- **Site-wide tag** (Google Analytics, Google Ads, or Google Tag Manager): add the tracking snippet once in the file `src/app/layout.tsx`. In a Next.js project the recommended way is Next's `Script` component. Google Tag Manager is the simplest if you'll manage multiple tags.
- **Conversion tracking** (e.g. "form submitted", "called us"): the contact and quote forms live in `src/components/ContactForm.tsx`, `HeroQuoteForm.tsx` and `QuoteModal.tsx`. Each has a "success" moment after a form is sent — that's the natural place to fire a conversion event. Phone links use `tel:` and can be tracked as click events.

Because it's a standard Next.js App Router site hosted on Vercel, any normal Google Ads / GA4 / GTM setup guide for Next.js applies directly.

Good to know

- **Change the admin password** for the live site — don't reuse a test one.
- The `/admin` area is intentionally hidden from Google search. Leave that as-is.
- Content and uploaded images on the live site are stored in Vercel's storage (Step 5), not in the code files — so they're safe across future code updates.
- Any change pushed to the GitHub repository automatically redeploys the site on Vercel.
- The project also includes `HANDOFF.md`, a shorter technical summary aimed at developers, if your team wants the under-the-hood details.

